

Data Retention & Privacy Policy

Northwind Global Technologies, Inc. · Corporate Policy · Data Governance

Owner	Data Protection Officer (DPO)	Category	Data Governance
Version	4.0	Document Name	POL-DG-007 Data Retention & Privacy Policy
Effective Date	2025-07-30	Review Date	2026-07-30

1. Purpose

This policy governs how personal and business data is collected, stored, retained, and disposed of, ensuring compliance with applicable data protection laws including GDPR and CCPA, and minimizing risk from over-retention of data.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all structured and unstructured data held by Northwind Global Technologies, Inc., including customer records, employee records, and operational data, across all storage systems and jurisdictions.

3. Policy Statements

- Personal data must be processed lawfully, fairly, and only for the purposes for which it was collected.
- Data must be retained only as long as necessary; default retention is 7 years for financial records and 24 months for marketing data.
- Data subject requests for access, correction, or erasure must be fulfilled within 30 days.
- Records scheduled for disposal must be securely and irreversibly destroyed.
- Cross-border transfers require an approved transfer mechanism such as Standard Contractual Clauses.

A data retention schedule is maintained as Appendix A and reviewed annually by the DPO and Legal.

4. Responsibilities

The DPO owns this policy and oversees compliance. Data owners classify data and apply retention rules. IT operations implement automated retention and deletion controls. All staff must report personal-data breaches within 24 hours of discovery.

5. Enforcement

Non-compliance may expose the company to regulatory fines and reputational harm and may result in disciplinary action. Exceptions to retention periods require legal-hold authorization.

Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
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1.0	2018-05-25	R. Ahmed	Initial GDPR-aligned release.
2.0	2020-01-01	R. Ahmed	Added CCPA provisions.
3.0	2023-07-30	M. Cho	Introduced automated deletion controls.
4.0	2025-07-30	M. Cho	Updated retention schedule and breach SLAs.